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Website Redesign Proposal

Prepared for Seahorse Suites · seahorsesuites.com · Sanibel Island, FL

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Prepared for: **Seahorse Suites** (seahorsesuites.com)

Thank you for the opportunity to review seahorsesuites.com. Rather than describing what a new website *could* look like, we have built a working preview of it. This document summarizes what we found on your current site, what the new build already does differently — visually, commercially, and technically — and the investment required to take it live. A few questions are embedded throughout; your answers will let us finalize scope.

Part 1: Current State Summary

The current seahorsesuites.com is a WordPress site built with the Elementor page builder (v4.0.9). It presents the property warmly and covers the essentials — five suites, an amenities page, and a contact form — but our audit surfaced issues that limit it both as a marketing asset and as a booking engine.

Finding	Impact
The main “Reserve Now” button links to the Suites page — often the page the visitor is already on. No path leads to an actual booking.	The most important call to action on the site is a dead end. Guests must leave and search Airbnb/Vrbo themselves.
The check-in/check-out form collects dates and party size but only sends an email — no availability, no confirmation, no next step. Guests are capped at 4, though several suites sleep more.	Lost bookings and mismatched expectations; inquiries instead of reservations.
Dozens of broken/empty image slots across the homepage and Suites page.	Missing photos on a business whose product is the visuals.
Social media icons link to “#” — placeholders for accounts that don't exist.	Dead clicks and an unfinished impression.
A raw WhatsApp video file is served directly from the media library.	Large unoptimized download; slow on the mobile connections guests actually use.
English only.	Florida's visitor mix includes a large Spanish-speaking market the site cannot serve.
No structured data (Schema.org lodging markup), generic titles, no localized meta.	Google cannot surface the property properly in local/travel results.
Elementor page-builder stack: heavy CSS/JS payload, render-blocking assets, plugin chain on every load.	Slower Core Web Vitals (a Google ranking factor) plus permanent plugin/security maintenance burden.

None of this is unusual for a first-generation small-business site — it got Seahorse Suites online. But each item above is either a leaked booking or a maintenance liability.

Part 2: What We Built — The Working Preview

We rebuilt the site from scratch on a modern stack, and you can click through it today. Each area below follows the same pattern: what exists now, and what the new build does.

2.1 Brand & Visual Experience

The Reality: A generic template look; the seahorse logo sits in the corner but the brand stops there. Broken galleries undercut the premium feel the suites deserve.

The New Build: A complete brand system built around your filigree seahorse and the #40d6dc ocean palette: elegant serif display typography (Cormorant Garamond) with a warm body font (Quicksand); a full-screen hero video with copy written to sell the feeling (“Steps from the Gulf. A world from everything else.”); animated translucent waves, scroll-triggered reveals, a parallax attractions section, a floating seahorse watermark, and an immersive full-screen mobile menu. Every hover, transition, and loading state is deliberate.

2.2 The Booking Funnel (Business Impact)

The Reality: “Reserve Now” circles back to the Suites page; the date form emails you and leaves the guest waiting.

The New Build: Every primary call to action opens a booking chooser: one tap to your Airbnb host profile, or directly to the individual Vrbo/Airbnb listing for a specific suite. Each of the five suites now has its own dedicated page — gallery, amenities, specs, description — with a sticky “Book this suite” card holding its two direct listing links. The path from “I like this suite” to “I’m on its booking page” is one click, from every page. A guest-review section with your 5.0 rating, Airbnb Guest Favourite / Superhost and Vrbo Premier Host badges supplies the social proof that converts lookers into bookers.

2.3 Content & Local SEO Architecture

The Reality: Three pages plus suite listings; the neighborhood gems (Magic Bus, Wickies, EmOcean) are name-dropped on the homepage with broken images.

The New Build: A 15+ page architecture in English and Spanish: home, suites index, 5 individual suite pages, amenities, contact, and 6 dedicated local guide pages (Sanibel Lighthouse, “Ding” Darling Wildlife Refuge, world-famous shelling, Magic Bus, Wickies, EmOcean). The guides answer what travelers actually search for and funnel that traffic to your booking links. All copy was rewritten around Old Town Sanibel's genuine strengths — the lighthouse walk, the Sanibel Stoop, 25 miles of bike paths that pair with your free guest bicycles.

2.4 Backend & Infrastructure

The Reality: WordPress + Elementor + plugins on traditional hosting — a database-driven system that must be patched, updated, and secured indefinitely.

The New Build: A static, pre-rendered site (Nuxt 4) served from Firebase's global CDN. No database to hack, no plugins to renew, no admin panel to secure. Contact and newsletter forms run on a serverless Cloud Function with validation, reCAPTCHA v3 spam protection, an email notification to you, and an

automatic branded confirmation to the guest. Legacy URLs will be 301-redirected so no search equity is lost.

2.5 Performance & SEO

The Reality: Page-builder payloads, unoptimized media, no structured data.

The New Build: Pre-rendered static HTML (sub-second first paint), an automated WebP image pipeline, aggressive CDN cache headers, lazy-loaded media. SEO is implemented, not sprinkled: per-page localized titles/descriptions, automatic sitemap + robots + canonicals, EN/ES hreflang alternates, Open Graph share images, and Schema.org LodgingBusiness structured data (address, geo, pet policy, amenities) — the markup Google's local and travel results feed on.

Side-by-side

	Current Site	New Build
Platform	WordPress + Elementor + plugins	Static Nuxt 4 on Firebase CDN
Booking path	Dead-end button + email form	1-click to Airbnb/Vrbo, per suite, from every page
Suite presentation	One shared page, broken galleries	Dedicated page per suite with direct booking links
Languages	English	English + Spanish
Local SEO	None	6 local guide pages + LodgingBusiness structured data
Performance	Builder payload, raw video files	Pre-rendered static pages, optimized media
Maintenance	Plugin updates, patching, backups	No database, no plugins, nothing to patch

Part 3: What We Need From You

1. Photography: A photo set per suite (gallery slots are ready for a hero shot + 4 photos each), plus property, backyard, and neighborhood shots. Existing listing photos work — we'll optimize them.

2. Listing URLs: The Vrbo listing URL for each of the five suites, and each suite's individual Airbnb listing URL (we already link your Airbnb host profile).

3. Cancellation policy: The current text, so we carry it over (and translate it).

4. Access: Domain registrar/DNS access for the launch swap, and Google Analytics/Search Console access (or we create them fresh).

5. Spanish review: Our Spanish copy is complete; a quick read-through from your side is welcome before launch.

6. Question: Do you want nightly rate ranges displayed on the site, or should pricing live exclusively on the booking platforms (current behavior)?

Part 4: Investment

Market context. Industry pricing guides for 2026 place template-based boutique lodging sites at **\$5,000–\$15,000** and custom-designed independent/boutique hotel sites at **\$20,000–\$35,000**, with custom hotel builds ranging **\$10,000–\$50,000** overall.¹ Our fixed bid sits deliberately at the accessible end of that range for a five-suite property — because the build is already substantially complete and you can verify exactly what you're buying before signing.

Tier 1 — Launch the New Site (Fixed Bid): \$7,400

Everything shown in the working preview, finished and live on seahorsesuites.com.

Work Item	What It Covers	Cost
Brand & design system	Logo system, palette, typography, animation language, mobile experience	\$1,600
Site build (15+ pages, bilingual)	Home, suites index, 5 suite pages, amenities, 6 local guides, contact — EN + ES	\$2,600
Booking funnel	Platform-choice modal, per-suite Airbnb/Vrbo deep links, trust/review section	\$700
Forms backend	Serverless functions, validation, reCAPTCHA, notifications + guest confirmations	\$900
SEO package	Structured data, localized meta, sitemap/hreflang/canonicals, 301 redirect map	\$800
Performance, QA & launch	Media optimization pipeline, cross-device QA, DNS swap, analytics setup	\$800
Total		\$7,400

Decisive-client pricing: \$5,550 (25% off) if we sign within 14 days of this proposal.

We'll be transparent about why: we're a small team, and long sales cycles are where our resources actually go. When a client can decide quickly, our cost to serve them drops — so we pass that difference on rather than pricing every project as if it will take months to close. After the 14-day window, Tier 1 reverts to the standard \$7,400.

Partner pricing — locked in when you sign within the window: your **next website project with us at 10% off**, and the **one after that at 20% off**. Once we've built your brand system and infrastructure, follow-up projects genuinely cost us less to deliver — so returning clients shouldn't pay first-project prices. *Valid for projects commissioned within 24 months, of similar or smaller scope; not combinable with other promotional discounts.*

Tier 2 — Launch + Content & Local SEO Package: \$9,900

Tier 1, plus: full curation and optimization of your photo library across all gallery slots, a real hero video edit from your footage, Google Business Profile optimization (categories, photos, booking links), review schema, GA4 + Search Console configuration, and 60 days of post-launch search tuning. *(The 14-day decisive-client discount applies to the Tier 1 portion of this package: \$8,050 within the window.)*

Tier 3 — Direct Bookings (Future Phase, two ways to get there)

Both options add what guests increasingly expect — checking availability and booking without leaving your site — and both cut into the **10–17% you currently pay in platform commissions**. Billed as a separate phase once Tier 1 or 2 is live.

Option A — In-House Availability & Direct Booking: \$6,500 – \$8,500, no monthly software. We build it ourselves on your existing infrastructure: live availability calendars on every suite page (syncd from your Airbnb/Vrbo calendars via their iCal feeds), and direct booking with secure Stripe checkout. When a guest books direct, the platforms' calendars are blocked automatically via the same mechanism. *The honest caveat:* iCal syncs on a delay (platforms refresh roughly every couple of hours), which leaves a small double-booking window. For a five-suite property with moderate volume this risk is low and manageable — but it is real, and we'd rather you know it than discover it.

Option B — Full Automation via Channel Manager: \$14,500 – \$18,500 + ~\$40–70/mo. Integration with a professional channel manager (Lodgify, OwnerRez, or Hostaway): true two-way, near-real-time sync through the platforms' official partner APIs, rate management, unified inbox, and automated tax handling. This is the “set it and forget it” version — the monthly subscription is the price of eliminating the sync-delay risk entirely.

Our recommendation: start with Option A. If direct booking volume grows to where the sync window worries you, the upgrade path to Option B is clean — nothing built in Option A is wasted.

Part 5: Ongoing Operating Costs

This is where the new architecture quietly earns its keep. Because the site is delivered as static files from a pay-as-you-go CDN, your fixed monthly costs approach zero.

Item	New Site	Current (WordPress)
Hosting	\$0–5/mo (Firebase free tier covers typical traffic)	\$10–40/mo managed WP hosting
Forms backend	\$0–2/mo (serverless free tier)	Included, but via plugins
Page builder / plugin licenses	\$0	~\$60–200/yr (Elementor Pro + renewals)
Security patching & backups	\$0 — nothing to patch	DIY risk, or \$50–150/mo retainer
Domain renewal	~\$15–20/yr (unchanged)	~\$15–20/yr

Item	New Site	Current (WordPress)
Analytics, Search Console, reCAPTCHA	\$0	\$0
Booking platform fees	Transaction-based (unchanged)	Same

Realistic total: roughly \$0–7/month in infrastructure, versus an equivalent WordPress footprint typically running \$25–60+/month once hosting, licenses, and maintenance are counted honestly.

Optional care plan: If you'd like us on call for content updates, seasonal photo swaps, new suite pages, and monitoring: **\$95/month** (up to 2 hours of changes) — optional, cancel anytime, never required for security reasons.

If Tier 3 is added later: Option A adds only Stripe's card processing (~2.9% + 30¢ per direct transaction — versus the 10–17% the platforms take today). Option B additionally carries the channel manager subscription at ~\$40–70/month. Either way, the fees are offset by the OTA commissions direct bookings avoid.

Next Steps

1. Click through the preview and mark anything you'd like changed.
2. Answer the questions in Part 3 (photos, Vrbo/Airbnb URLs, DNS access).
3. Pick a tier. We finalize the agreement, complete the content, and schedule the DNS swap — the public sees the new site instantly, with zero downtime and all legacy URLs redirected.

¹ Market pricing references: Qrolic “Hotel & Resort Website Cost 2026”; Hooray Agency “Custom Hotel Website Cost 2026”; RevPARGenius “How Much Should a Hotel Website Cost 2026”.